SPEECH

WHO HOLDS THE PAINTBRUSH?

SAYANJEET · OPENING | 4 SLIDES | ~85-90 SECONDS | → CLICK = press next

01
THE PAINTBRUSH
AGITPROP POSTER
~25 S

Good morning. We chose *Animal Farm*, and our title, *A Warning in Seven Commandments*, comes from this idea.

We usually learn it as history in costume: Napoleon is Stalin, Snowball is Trotsky. True.

→ CLICK switch flips But what unsettled me was how easily the animals were talked out of their own memories.

The pigs don't lie outright. They control the record, and they hold the paintbrush.

02
WHO CAN READ?
BARN-WALL POSTER
~20 S

Look at who can read. The pigs, perfectly. Boxer, never past D. The sheep can't hold seven rules.

→ CLICK the slogan So Snowball shrinks them into one slogan, and the farm learns to chant instead of think.

When the pigs need to drown out a protest, the sheep are ready.

03
WRITTEN DOWN?
DOSSIER POSTER
~18 S

Then Squealer asks: "Is it written down anywhere?"

Here's one record. Chapter Four: Snowball is a hero.

→ CLICK Ch. VII Chapter Seven: his medal was "our mistake."

→ CLICK Ch. IX Chapter Nine: his wounds came from Napoleon's teeth.

Whoever holds the record holds the past.

04
34 READERS
NETWORK POSTER
~25 S

Thirty-four classmates replied to my review, and fifteen pushed back.

→ CLICK records & memory The memory idea travelled furthest, and one reader sharpened it: the animals aren't short of text, they're short of control over it.

→ CLICK too easily fooled And my weakest line, that the animals are "too easily fooled," was challenged every time. They're frightened, hungry and exhausted.

So read it a second time: for the Commandments, not the Revolution.

(Over to [next speaker].)

CUE CARDS

ONLY THE KEYWORDS

Print and cut along the dashed lines: one card per slide, read top to bottom. → *= press next.*

01 THE PAINTBRUSH ~25 s

- Our title: Seven Commandments
- History in costume — Stalin, Trotsky. True.
- → Talked out of their memories
- Control the record · hold the paintbrush

Opens with: **"Good morning. We chose Animal Farm…"**

02 WHO CAN READ? ~20 s

- Pigs perfectly · Boxer, D · sheep, seven rules
- → One slogan · chant, not think
- Drown out a protest — sheep are ready

Opens with: **"Look at who can read."**

03 WRITTEN DOWN? ~18 s

- "Is it written down anywhere?"
- Ch. IV — hero
- → Ch. VII — "our mistake"
- → Ch. IX — Napoleon's teeth
- Record = past

Opens with: **"Then Squealer asks…"**

04 34 READERS ~25 s

- 34 replied · 15 pushed back
- → Not short of text — short of control
- → "Too easily fooled"? Frightened, hungry, exhausted
- Commandments, not Revolution

Opens with: **"Thirty-four classmates…"**

IF YOU GO BLANK

Say: **"The pigs don't need to lie; they just control the record."** Then carry on with the next slide.

Slide	Builds	What happens on screen (the dots by the slide number show builds left)
01	1 build	The switch flips to "My reading"; the brush paints WITH SHEETS.
02	1 build	The seven rules collapse into the slogan; the chant drowns out the protest.
03	2 builds	The Cowshed record is revised to Chapter VII, then Chapter IX.
04	2 builds	"Records & memory" lights up (16), then "too easily fooled" and the balance tips.

Q&A + PRACTICE

BE READY

LIKELY QUESTIONS

"ISN'T IT JUST ABOUT STALIN?"

It is, and that reading is accurate. But it fits anyone who controls the archive, which is why it still feels current in 2026.

"WHO'S THE WORST CHARACTER?"

Napoleon acts, but Benjamin troubled me most. He reads as well as any pig and says nothing, and clear vision without action is useless.

"WHY SAY THE ANIMALS AREN'T STUPID?"

A classmate said "count the dogs": almost every time the animals accept an explanation, dogs are growling nearby. They've learned what disagreement costs.

"WHY SEVEN COMMANDMENTS?"

That's where the record gets rewritten: "with sheets," "to excess," "without cause."

LEARNING PLAN · ABOUT 75 MINUTES

1 10 min

Read the speech aloud three times with the deck open, pressing → at each cue.

2 20 min

One slide at a time: say each slide three times without looking, using only its cue card.

3 15 min

Learn the four openers that chain the slides: "history in costume" / "Look at who can read" / "Is it written down anywhere?" / "Thirty-four classmates."

4 15 min

Three full runs with a timer. Aim for 85–90 seconds.

5 10 min

Say the four Q&A answers aloud.

6 next morning

One full run, start to finish, before you leave.

DELIVERY TIPS

1. Pause for a beat after slide 1 flips. The visual does the work.
2. On slide 2, keep talking while the chant plays. Land "the sheep are ready" as the green caption appears, about 4–5 seconds after you press.
3. On slide 4, stress the numbers: "thirty-four," "fifteen."